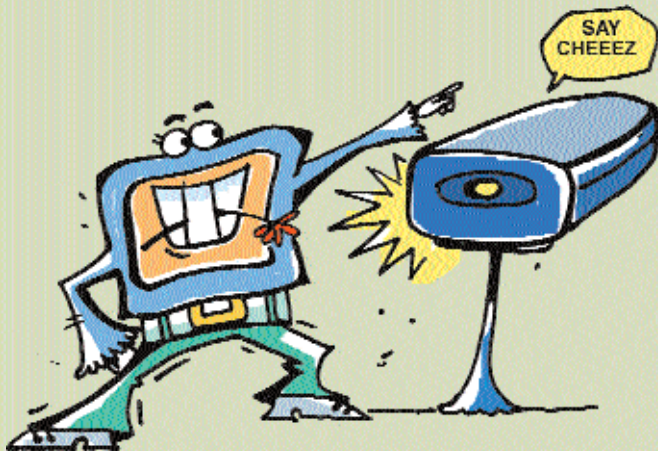


DIGITAL PHOTOGRAPHY

Use these tips to breeze through a photo shoot using a digital camera!



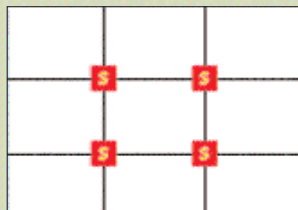
Focusing

You might face this problem if you use an auto-focus camera—the camera captures the distant background and blurs the subject. This is because cameras are usually designed to have a central focus. The solution is quite simple. Point the camera at the subject and position it in the centre of the frame. Keep the shutter button pressed halfway down to lock the focus on the subject and re-position the camera so the scene is framed to your liking. Finally, press the shutter button down completely to take a snapshot.

The Rule of Thirds

One of the most popular rules of photography, it applies to both traditional, as well as digital photography. According to this rule, if the frame of the viewfinder were to be divided into thirds, both hor-

izontally and vertically, then the four intersections are the best places to put your subject, instead of the centre of the frame. This yields an



Follow the Rule of Thirds to click appealing photos

appealing image.

In case of a landscape shoot that needs an emphasis on the sky, get the horizon on the lower horizontal grid.

Foreground and background

Zoom in and choose a large aperture setting for sharper foregrounds and blurred backgrounds. This setting is

appropriate for portrait photos. Zooming out and choosing a small aperture results in an equal focus on the background and foreground.

Shooting fireworks

Snap up those beautiful fireworks using a digital camera with a shutter speed longer than $\frac{1}{2}$ a second. Ideally, opt for a shutter speed between 2 to 10 seconds to capture all the sparkle and razzmatazz. You will also need a tripod to avoid jerky, haphazard photos. Eliminate even the slightest possibility of vibration by using a camera that comes equipped with a remote shutter release.

Set ISO to the lowest setting to reduce noise—the tiny dots across such snaps. Enable long exposure noise reduction, if the camera comes with it.

Preview the shot on the LCD screen, and accordingly adjust the aperture so that it's just the right size to get bright sharp photos. Keep spare batteries with you.

Warm tones

Normally, the default white balance setting for most digital cameras is set to 'Auto'. Though this is fine in most cases, sunny landscapes and portraits taken in bright light could turn out dull. Hence, change its setting to 'Cloudy' to get warmer reds and yellows that make the picture look better.

Polarising filter

Polarising filter is used for outdoor shoots since it

reduces glare and reflection, and results in more saturated colours, especially in the case of sky. Use your sunglasses in case your camera doesn't have support for one. Place the glasses as close to the camera as possible, check the LCD to see that its frame does not obstruct the view and shoot. For better results, use it when the light source and the subject are at right angles, i.e., when the sun is exactly over your head. Further, set the white balance to 'Cloudy' for warmer photos.

Flash modes

Normally, digital cameras have three flash modes—Auto Flash, Fill Flash and Red Eye Reduction.

Auto Flash mode is used for general photography. In this mode, the flash determines whether it needs to be fired or not, based on the amount of light present. This mode is represented on the LCD by a lightning icon with a capital 'A'.

In the case of Fill Flash, the flash is always fired. This is useful when the subject is sitting in the shade with bright sunlight around. If set to Auto, the flash would not have fired, resulting in dark spots around the eyes. In the Red-Eye Reduction mode, the flash is fired several times before the shutter actually opens. Thus, the eye-pupils are contracted and the red-eye effect reduces. Use this mode when there is very little light and the photo depends on the flash.